



Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack

News Release

For Release:

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TANDY CORPORATION AND EDUCATION SYSTEMS TECHNOLOGY CORPORATION OFFER SOPHISTICATED LEARNING SYSTEM FOR ELEMENTARY SCHOOLS

Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack®, a leader in educational computing, has entered into a cooperative marketing agreement with Education Systems Technology Corporation (ESTC) to offer one of the most sophisticated integrated learning systems available for elementary schools today.

Designed by 50 of the nation's foremost professionals on reading and mathematics, the ESTC instructional learning system includes three major components:

- 1) A comprehensive 1500 lesson reading and mathematics curriculum for elementary grades (K-6).
- 2) A Tandy-based computer laboratory composed of one Tandy® 3000 host computer and up to 40 Tandy® 1000 personal computer student workstations, allowing an entire class to use the system at once.
- 3) An on-site facility management service, which includes an ESTC lab attendant and a complete computer-controlled student management and performance reporting system.

Tandy is the first major microcomputer manufacturer to offer

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a complete elementary school math and reading curriculum with management.

"This agreement between Tandy and ESTC allows Tandy to use its position of strength in the education market to help bring ESTC's exceptionally high-quality, complete education system to the schools," said Bill Gattis, vice president of Tandy's Education Division. "It is the most complete elementary school curriculum available for use on microcomputers."

Reading instruction focuses on four learning concepts: word analysis; vocabulary; study skills; and comprehension.

Mathematics instruction focuses on eight learning concepts: numeration; addition and subtraction; multiplication and division; geometry; measurement; estimation and mental computation; generating and interpreting data; and problem solving strategies.

"Five years of research on computers and instruction were undertaken before these programs were written," explained Dr. Cecil J. Hannan, chairman of ESTC. "Students in our test programs repeatedly asked to return to do more mathematical problems, largely because these programs teach students how to think in an exciting and productive manner."

"Computers have made individualized instruction cost effective for the first time in history," he added, "and the quality of the ESTC program is equalled by the quality of Tandy's delivery system."

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The system is unique in that it will be an "open" system, enabling any major publishing company to design software integratable with the ESTC management system, and in that the Tandy 1000 personal computer student workstations can be used for other applications. Jimmie Thompson, manager of Publisher Relations for Radio Shack's Education Division, states that he will be "encouraging and assisting" those educational publishers with whom Tandy has cooperative marketing agreements to modify their existing elementary software using the ESTC management system.

Each student workstation includes three devices for student interaction: a keyboard, headphones and a Digi-Mouse™ with the ability to move words, pictures and even sentences on the screen. The computer speaks from a resident synthesized vocabulary. High-resolution color graphics and music illustrate concepts, reinforce learning and enhance understanding.

The student management system built into the curriculum provides teachers with instant progress reports and immediate feedback on a student learning at his/her own pace.

"The instructional content of this system was developed by proven, professional classroom teachers, supervised by a group of nationally recognized educators," said John T. Kernan, president of ESTC.

Preliminary research studies indicate higher student achievement levels in critical thinking skills. The ESTC

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learning system has been field tested in San Diego County,
California schools.

"ESTC's curriculum does not seek to replace the existing curriculum or teacher. Rather, our approach is to complement and enhance the school's commitment to quality reading and math education. The ESTC Reading and Mathematics learning system offers the highest quality software, hardware and support available anywhere," Kernan explained.

For more information, interested customers should contact a Tandy Regional Education Coordinator by calling 1-800-433-5628.

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